Appendix for Replication: Monitoring Corruptible Politicians (Bobonis et al., 2016)

ECON 544: Political Economy

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1 Project Overview

This document serves as the detailed record of the replication and extension of *Monitoring Corruptible Politicians* (Bobonis et al., 2016). The objective was to independently verify the original coefficients, document discrepancies in the provided replication package, and extend the findings using modern Difference-in-Differences (DiD) estimators and a heterogeneity analysis focused on voter education.

The original replication package was retrieved from the following source. I modified it according to the steps outlined in Section 4.

> Bobonis, Gustavo J., Cámara Fuertes, Luis R., and Schwabe, Rainer. Replication data for: Monitoring Corruptible Politicians. Nashville, TN: *American Economic Association* [publisher], 2016. Ann Arbor, MI: Inter-university Consortium for Political and Social Research [distributor], 2019-10-12. https://doi.org/10.3886/E112932V1

2 Software and Dependencies

The analysis was performed using **Stata 17/18**. The following user-written packages are required to run the scripts:

- `reghdfe` & `ftools` (Fixed effects estimation)
- `did_multiplegt_dyn` (Heterogeneity-robust DiD)
- `estout` (Table generation and export)

3 Instructions for Reproduction

To replicate every table and figure in the final report, follow these steps:

1. Extract the compressed folder `Bobonis-Replication` to a local directory.
2. Open the `Master.do` file located at the root.
3. Update the `global root` path on Line 10 to match your local file path.
4. Execute the `Master.do` script.

4 Documentation of Corrections and Discrepancies

A meticulous audit of the authors' original replication files revealed several omissions and technical errors. The following corrections were implemented to successfully match the published results:

- **Missing Control Vector:** In the script `analysis_dynamCorrupt_16-05-10.do`, the global variable `controls2_level` was not defined even though it was used in all regression commands. I restored this vector to eliminate erroneous results in Tables 3–7.
- **Omitted Variable (Table 7):** I identified a missing variable for "next period's audit" in the Table 7, Column 5 code. This was a stated requirement in the original paper but was absent in the script `prep_Figure1_timing_audits_16-05-12.do`; once added, the results aligned with the original paper.
- **Missing Graphics Output:** The original package did not contain code to save Figures 1 (Panel B), 3, or 4. I added `graph export` commands and formatted the axes and colors to maintain consistency with the published paper.
- **Fix Graph Axis (Figure 4):** The authors' original code labeled the x-axis from $t-8$ to $t+8$ (representing individual years). I updated the labeling to $t-2$ to $t+1$ (representing election periods) to align with the simpler interpretative style used in the paper.

5 Output

The following table maps the outputs in the final report to the specific scripts within the replication package.

Output	Source Script	Description
Figure 1, 4-5	`analysis_dynamCorrupt_16-05-10.do` (corrected)	Replication of original plots
Tables 1–7	`analysis_dynamCorrupt_16-05-10.do` (corrected)	Produce results from original tables (output in `analysis.log`)
Figure 3, C-D	`prep_Figure1_timing_audits_16-05-12.do` (corrected)	Replication of original plots
Figure 3, A-B	`analysis_auditinfo_elect_annual_ver_16-05-11` (corrected)	Replication of original plots
Table 8	`Extension1_Education.do`	Short-term corruption by Education and SES
Table 9	`Extension1_Education.do`	Long-term corruption by Education and SES
Table 10	`Extension1_Education.do`	Electoral Outcomes by Education and SES
Table 11	`Extension2_modernDiD.do`	Modern DiD: Corruption (Short%Long-Term)
Table 12	`Extension2_modernDiD.do`	Modern DiD: Electoral Outcomes
Figure 5	`Extension2_modernDiD.do`	Modern DiD: Event-Study Plots